

Tobias Treppmann

The last stretch is a design-technology problem now

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

I lead design functions, and the last year went into the layer underneath the craft. At Bibel TV I own UI quality across iOS, Android, web and connected TV. I prototype in real code against real production APIs and engineering ships from that code. The quality bar is enforced by the build rather than by review. Assistants write the first draft now, and their output renders whether or not it is right.

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off-system values the build caught in a library believed clean after two cleanup passes

Six countries

one product delivered under EU accessibility and church data-protection law

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV; engineering supplied by an external agency) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- The quality bar, implemented — six checks, identical on a laptop and in CI.
- What those checks catch — a token reference that does not resolve, and a color hardcoded into a component. Both render, so review never sees them.
- Design to code, across a company boundary — engineering is an external agency and ships from my prototype code.
- Modern UI foundations — DTCG tokens in four tiers, Style Dictionary, synced live to Figma and Android. One commit propagates to every platform.
- Craft at the pixel, owned as an algorithm — a color engine in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry even perceptual weight. WCAG contrast validated inside it.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines — Product Design and Product held together, July to October 2023. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Hired 2, promoted 2 — including the consultant who then took Head of Product. Ten years reviewing designers' work as a mentor alongside the day job.
- Design made co-equal by agreement rather than assertion — a collaborative UX-maturity self-assessment with product and engineering. Motion belonged to the system, as custom easing curves.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP — ~50 people, DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Advocating for the right build, through delivery — the internal plan was a standalone add-on module. I delivered an embedded platform capability. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance.
- Six markets, one product, under regulation — we audited our website and also the websites customers build with the platform, for EU Accessibility Act compliance.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- A functional head among functional heads — I led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years, trading scope with product and engineering counterparts.
- Component behavior and specs across the library — I defined how components behaved and what they promised; the UI designers executed the visual system. Motion as custom easing curves.

UX Strategy Lead

2014 – 2016

Spreadshirt (international e-commerce, hundreds of thousands of consumers — 200+ people) · Leipzig, Germany

- Shipped what the company had twice failed to ship — a nine-month seller-experience redesign. Leadership wanted a 60-second automated journey; shop owners valued the design step most, and the strategy moved.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

SKILLS

Design Technology and the Design-Engineering Boundary

Prototypes in real code against real production APIs, with an external engineering agency shipping from that code · engineering ships from that code · DTCG tokens in four tiers with Style Dictionary and live sync to Figma and Android · Storybook as the source of truth with a prototyping layer on top

AI-Native Practice, and the Bar It Has to Meet

Six checks that run identically on a laptop and in CI and refuse off-system work · The token vocabulary handed to the assistant as an enumerated list, so it cannot invent · Figma, Claude Code, Claude skills, Cursor and Zed as daily tools

Craft and Quality

A color engine live in production, k-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB · Text validated against base with the WCAG algorithm until the pair passes, so nothing ships failing contrast · Motion carried by the design system as custom easing curves at Ninox and Datameer · Selah — Mindful Transitions, a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store

Leading, Hiring and Critique

Product Design and Product held together at Ninox, nine reports across four disciplines, Senior Leadership Team · Hired two, promoted two; coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship · A functional head among functional heads at Datameer, leading the design team across Germany and NYC for five years · Ten years reviewing and critiquing designers' work as a senior mentor at CareerFoundry

Consistency at Scale, Across Markets

One product across six countries at ChurchDesk, audited under the EU Accessibility Act · Localized product across DACH, the UK and the US at Ninox; the US, Canada and the UK at Datameer · Consistency across iOS, Android, web and connected TV held from a single token source · At ChurchDesk the internal plan was a standalone add-on module; I delivered an embedded platform capability instead

Agency, and Turning Ambiguity into Clarity

Bibel TV was a fast-changing environment with no design team and no in-house engineering. I introduced agentic engineering from zero and shipped the token API and color engine · At Ninox, design was made co-equal from first principles through a collaborative self-assessment rather than an imposed structure · Just enough structure to ship at speed: design-system governance as a working group with an escalation path, not a committee · Founder-level engagement with a CEO and technical co-founder on the prompt-to-database onboarding · A high personal bar for detail, installed as checks rather than as review